

# ENDING YOUR SOLO!

## FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #170

Ending a solo sounds easy enough, right . . . just stop playing! Well, your favorite movie didn't end by just stopping filming, and a great book doesn't come to a conclusion when they run out of paper. There is a lot of craft and art to *really* ending a statement clearly.

There are two main considerations to truly ENDING your solo, your artistic statement.

- 1) You are ending your MELODY, so the more you know about melodies, the more tools you have to shape *your* melody, to make it sound like it's coming to an end.
- 2) If you are playing LIVE, body language is very important to help you communicate with your fellow musicians.

### #1 - Last 8 measures of "Lullaby Of Birdland," quoting the melody

Chord progression for the first exercise:

Fm7 Dø7 G7 C7 Fm7 Bbm7 Eb7

Abmaj7 Fm7 Bbm7 Eb7 Abmaj7 Eb7 Abmaj7

#### SOME HINTS

- Play a long note in the last two measures of your solo.
- Play NOTHING (ie. a rest) for the last measure or two of your solo.
- Play a descending line for four or eight measures into the end of you solo.
- Have your volume decrease (decrescendo) during your last four or 8 measures.

### #2 - Last 8 measures, using a descending and repetitive line

Chord progression for the second exercise:

Fm7 Dø7 G7 C7 Fm7 Bbm7 Eb7

Abmaj7 Fm7 Bbm7 Eb7 Abmaj7 Abmaj7